

ENGINEERING WORKSHOP

Chrome DevTools Playground

Debug production issues like a real engineer.

Frontend

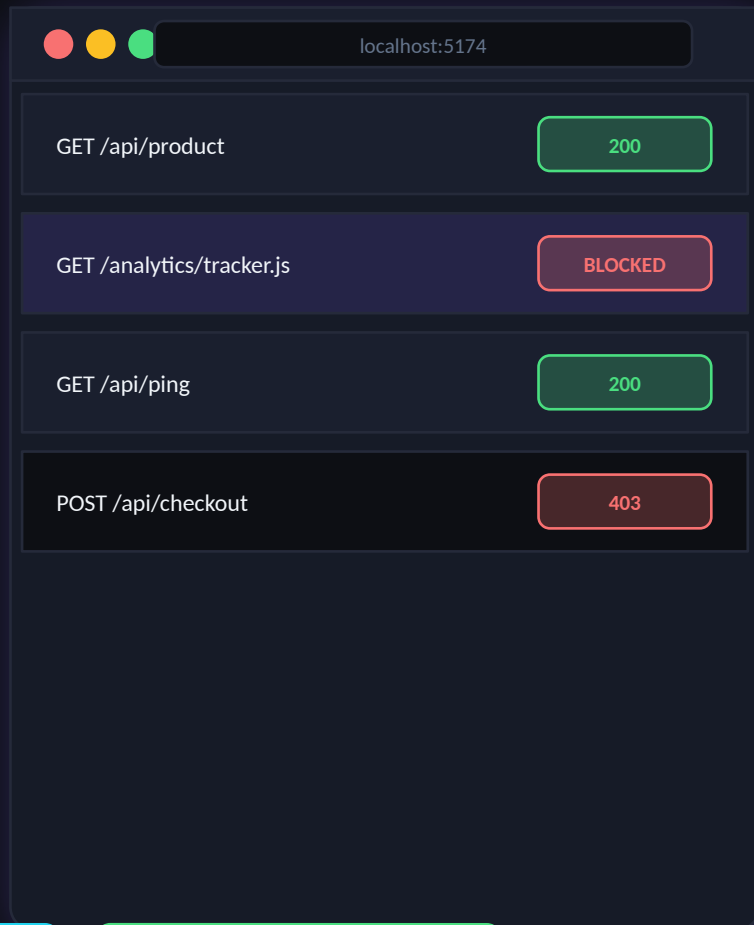
Fullstack

QA

PART 1 — CONTEXT

PART 2 — THE TASK

PART 3 — WHAT YOU LEARN



Production debugging is different.

You can't edit the source. You can't restart the server. You can't change what the API returns. But you can investigate.

Your only tool:

Chrome DevTools



Edit source code



Restart production



Change API responses



Disable 3rd-party services



DevTools lets you simulate all of these.

PART 1 — CONTEXT

THE SETUP

A user tries to buy headphones.



Wireless Pro Headphones X1

\$49 ~~\$999~~

But everything goes wrong.

YOUR MISSION

Complete the checkout using only
Chrome DevTools.



No source code edits



No backend access



No app restarts



Chrome DevTools Only

4 gates. Each one a real skill.

1

Wrong Price

PROBLEM

API returns \$999

TECHNIQUE

Local Overrides

REAL WORLD

Bad deploy, wrong data

2

Tracker Block

PROBLEM

Script disables Buy Now

TECHNIQUE

Block Request URL

REAL WORLD

Vendor outage, ad-blocker

3

Speed Check

PROBLEM

Checkout rejects fast RTT

TECHNIQUE

Per-Request Throttle

REAL WORLD

Slow dependency isolation

4

Missing Header

PROBLEM

Response header missing

TECHNIQUE

Override Headers

REAL WORLD

CORS, feature flags, API contracts

These 4 scenarios must be cleared in order — each one unlocks the next.

PART 2

Your turn.

Open the app. Start DevTools. Complete checkout.



localhost:5174

DevTools: F12 / Cmd+Opt+I

Network tab → start here

Work through the scenarios in order. Each one auto-completes when you solve it.

Each scenario teaches one transferable skill.

01 — Local Overrides

YOU LEARNED:

Rewrite any API response without touching code

IN REAL LIFE:

Validate UI behavior before backend is fixed

02 — Block Request URL

YOU LEARNED:

Simulate third-party failures instantly

IN REAL LIFE:

Test graceful degradation when a vendor goes down

03 — Per-Request Throttle

YOU LEARNED:

Slow one endpoint while the rest stays fast

IN REAL LIFE:

Isolate which dependency is causing slowness

04 — Override Headers

YOU LEARNED:

Inject any response header into a live request

IN REAL LIFE:

Debug CORS, feature flags, and API contract mismatches

The shift.

BEFORE

"I can't reproduce it."

AFTER

"I know exactly why it happens."



Debug production without code access



Validate assumptions before filing a ticket



Isolate third-party failures from your own bugs



Simulate network conditions per endpoint



Test edge cases without a staging environment



Produce actionable, reproducible bug reports

"Think like a production engineer."